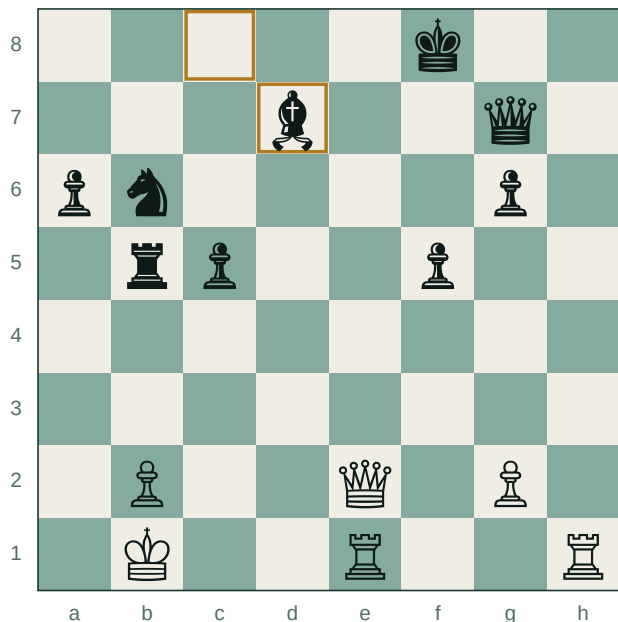


Exposed-king tactics: White, move 33

Exposed-king tactics

White to move



Previous move: 32...Bd7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

33. Rh8+ Qxh8 34. Qe7+ Kg8 35. Qd8+

33.Rh8+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **33...Qxh8**.

34.Qe7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From e7 it attacks king on f8 and bishop on d7. Recorded reply: **34...Kg8**.

35.Qd8+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From d8 it attacks king on g8, knight on b6 and bishop on d7.

At the end, nominal material is White 16 / Black 24 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -5: the balance goes from -3 to -8. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An exposed king gives the attacker checks and access to nearby squares. Coordinate pieces so the checks drive it into a worse net rather than toward safety.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on f8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.